

CLOSE CAPTIONS

by olivia lee

De profundis clamavi ad te Domine.
Each morning a vision came to me.

The Glass Essay, Anne Carson

The Glass Essay is a 36 page poem in which Anne Carson meditates on a former lover, the poems of Emily Brontë, and other intertwined topics. She self-describes the poem as an attempt at “understanding what life feels like.” My favorite moments in the poem are the Nudes. Carson defines these vignettes as naked glimpses into her soul. Thus, faced with the pieces of Anne Carson’s soul, I meditate on my own.

My soul is full of cycles and my mind is full of words.

I developed CLOSE CAPTIONS from my collected creative writing. Using Python, I segmented my work into sentences and used them to train a word-level Markov chain (N=2) to generate new text. I also ran my writing against a corpus of words semantically tagged as emotive, outlandish, sharp, and organic, and selected words that were both highly tagged and found in my work. From this list, I encoded a poem: words in my mind that attempt to construct themselves into coherence, hallucinating toward a center of truth, before degrading back into noise.

In these scenes, I am reflected in the pacing, the pairs, and the point.

These scenes are defined as transcriptions.

```

import sentencex
text = open("./olee_writing_dirty.txt").read()
sentences = sentencex.segment("\n", text)
sentences = [item.replace("\n", " ") for item in sentences if
len(item.strip()) > 0]

lex = []
lex = [key for key, val in cats_counted.items() if val['emotive'] >
4 or val['sharp'] > 4 or val['outlandish'] > 4 or val['organic'] >
4 ]

scenes = []

for sentence in sentences:
    for item in lex:
        if item in sentence:
            scenes.append(sentence)

scene_counts = {}

for line in scenes:
    scene_counts[line] = scene_counts.get(line, 0) + 1

with open("scenes.txt", "w") as f:
    for sc in scene_counts:
        f.write(sc + "\n")

text2 = open("./scenes.txt").read()
my_scenes = sentencex.segment("\n", text2)
my_scenes = [item.replace("\n", " ") for item in my_scenes if
len(item.strip()) > 0]

topics = [word for word in lex if any(word in scene for scene in
my_scenes)]

topics.remove("art")
topics.remove("evil")

gen = TextGenerator(n=2, tokenizer=SimpleWordTokenizer(),
source=sentences)
act = 1
scene_lines = []

```

Sources:

Aitken, Will. "Anne Carson." The Paris Review, no. 171 (Fall 2004).

Carson, Anne. "The Glass Essay." Poetry Foundation. Accessed April 13, 2026. <https://www.poetryfoundation.org/poems/48636/the-glass-essay>.

Parrish, Allison. "Shoestrings Tutorial." Shoestrings Tutorial, 2024. <https://github.com/aparrish/shoestrings/blob/main/shoestrings-tutorial.ipynb>.

Parrish, Allison. "Approaches to Vector Semantics." Approaches to Vector Semantics, 2024. <https://github.com/aparrish/rwet/blob/master/approaches-to-vector-semantics.ipynb>

Lee, Olivia. "Collected Exorcisms" & Other works. 2026

```
for i in range(1):
    for item in topics:
        print("SCENE: ", act)
        if len(item) > 6:
            print(item[:-6])
        if len(item) > 5:
            print(item[:-5])
        if len(item) > 4:
            print(item[:-4])
        if len(item) > 3:
            print(item[:-3])
        print(item[:-2])
        print(item[:-1])
        print(item)
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=3))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=4))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=5))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=6))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=7))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=8))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=9))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=10))

    for sc in scene_counts:
        if item in sc:
            trimmed = sc[sc.index(item):]
            words = trimmed.split()
            if len(words) >= 2:
                scene_lines.append(" ".join(words[:11]))

    if scene_lines:
        print(random.choice(scene_lines))
        scene_lines.clear()
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=10))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=9))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=8))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=7))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=6))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=5))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=4))
        print(gen.generate_one(start_string=item, max_tokens=3))
        print(item)
        print(item[:-1])
        print(item[:-2])
        if len(item) > 3:
            print(item[:-3])
        if len(item) > 4:
            print(item[:-4])
        if len(item) > 5:
            print(item[:-5])
        if len(item) > 6:
            print(item[:-6])

        print("\n\n")
        act += 1
```

SCENE: !
O
ot
oth
othe
other
others
others.
others.
others as a wood-
others.
others as well as how could get
others as my place to put me on
others as how you were two here, montage
others as your sin.
others as well as your indecision.
others as non- platonic strictly out of these are
others as I gave it.
others as much anxiety and how could kiss
others as I needed the same way
others.
others.
others as I wanted
others as how
others
other
othe
oth
ot
O

SCENE: !
t
ti
tim
time
time and time
time again anyway.
time was inspired by the
time and on sale!
time and the silence
time and you put it. No,
time and how I feel like I know you
time I play?
time, more rushed.
time and time and as much anxiety and an outline
time and how much about best?
time and feed the truth these people and
time.
time and right back home alone
time and still paying for
time again nineteen again
time and how
time
tim
ti
t

SCENE: 1
b
bo
bod
body
body, high
body, and still
body pale It' m
body, but three horrible weeks
body pale It' s only potential
body pale It' re glazing over top
body, it to the window- shopping
body, and take and time and unraveling at myself
body, a follower when he comes calling... On my knees, it's
body, leaving you desperate.
body, on it never found Before I write
body, would you?
body, and time and I can
body.
body, all the door
body, always do
body, when
body
bod
bo
b

SCENE: !
p
pe
peo
peop
people
people already suspect
people or periods in
people already think you almost
people were never feel.
people and the effects of sex was
people feel, when you... and tear
people there' s enough for long enough to
people there in your misery renders in the light.
people were talking, in fact they were asking and it all
people or speak again again
people and art book may appear resolved, my
people feel and yes, those who'
people and they love affair.
people' ve pushed for what
people in charge, how
people and die
people and I
people
peopl
peop
peo
pe
p

SCENE: 9

t
te
tea
tear
tears
tears, to
tears, remembered by
tears, suffer parts of
tears, you dismiss me in
tears, I can' s more
tears, it. How many times can
tears, yes, there were never could learn
tears, so I am[that was to send
tears, wasted, down the drain my always honest heartbreak disfiguring my
tears, on their feet.
tears, all got played.
tears, pray let sweet nothing.
tears, the chase.
tears, would you paper plane
tears, though hard just
tears, but no
tears, but
tears
tear
tea
te
t

SCENE: 1

b
bo
bod
body
body.
body.
body.
body, it for caring,
body.
body.
body pale It' s what we gawk?
body, pray, until I think, but you
body pale It's enough to window-shop the exotic wear and tear
body.
body, just a Feast
body, it around, beneath your type
body,
body, exploratory practice, maybe
body, all.
body, I have
body.
body
bod
bo
b

SCENE: !

w
wa
wat
wate
water
water, falling
water, it,
water, set a half
water, as" relationship,"
water, and why can' re
water, not sure pity and the flies
water, but just for you, but I
water, dust collecting enough, music, an object
water, fast, below our bridge.
water, maybe take everything.
water, shield, par dolori," you'
water, I possibly last night and more
water, exactly what I also spiraled
water, and cradle me down
water, demonstrating how this
water, but it
water, all
water
wate
wat
wa
w

SCENE: 2
w
wo
wor
worl
world
world and time
world to feel you
world to distance myself into
world and a secret{ with
world and suture up a subtle quirks
world and you.
world to close my memories and time and maybe
world to endure
world to you.
world to fuck up high.
world to hold me.
world to be true.
world and time and I was to
world to exist.
world to one buyer,
world and I was
world and spear
world
world
worl
wor
wo
w

SCENE: 8
l
lo
lov
love
love.
love you act like
love to the curb
love.
love.
love you to process all my life who
love.
love a game.
lovely, all that pain, when you put it on display!
love to dissect her
love it sticking with} me gathered what'
love to fill your eyes; crackle,
love to one i get out of
love for too
love me this pattern into
love you agree?
love Why am
love
lov
lo
l

SCENE: 2
w
wo
wor
worl
world
world and leave
world and restrained
world to look like you
world and layer them.
world and Teeth this view
world to the difference between a pretty face
world and die
world to pain and for myself, and again
world to you.
world to tear
world to haunt him make me. How you
world to process them.
world and I' re all that
world and stare
world to.
world and how the
world to be
world
worl
wor
wo
w

SCENE: 9
t
te
tea
tear
tears
tears, and
tears, dust
tears, I am bluer
tears, how to haunt,
tears, but still care once before
tears, but still
tears, falling from you?
tears, I started that nothing) just put on
tears, They Go back on a year eating up
tears, they tell will collect myself during them
tears, so all down til' m
tears, though hard, what(
tears, it dust
tears, i was open
tears, all,
tears, it
tears
tear
tea
te
t

SCENE: 8
1
lo
lov
love
love Why ever
love is the chase
love, my failings a
love to gut you to say
love and they' re pacing through
love to live all that you?
love affair.
love to look him, a break.
love a friend worth two.
love affair.
love a headache.
love Why is lost a quiet watching my
love do
love.
love.
love Why am burdened
love to fuck
love
lov
lo
1

SCENE: 8

1
lo
lov
love
love you want
love is intentionally arranged
love you?
love me to pass i'
love me in my silhouettes everything i
love.
love for another you act of these are my
love and retribution, but still
lovely, all that pain, when you put it on display!
love is intentionally arranged, but I can' ve
love to process them, and I wanna be
love you" to be rid, and
love to fragments, inside their own
love, would comfort me,
love to process my mind
love a widow..."
love, all
love
lov
lo
1

SCENE: 2
w
wo
wor
worl
world
world and time
world to fulfill needs
world to get in some
world and tear my dreams and
world to you... You aren'
world and how to fulfill needs to exist
world to me to you have no part.
world and I' s children.
world and my place in it, how I make sense of
world to talk again
world and how to hold me Binding my pocket
world and you did before.
world to park, I can'
world to me, an evening
world to reenact my mind
world to fix is
world and so
world
worl
wor
wo
w

SCENE: !
f
fi
fin
fing
finge
finger
fingers
fingers onto the
fingers onto the word
fingers onto the wall.
fingers onto the bean bags on
fingers onto the way you think that
fingers onto the midst of the floor.
fingers onto the base I' ve ever touched
fingers onto the shadows; All that desperately I needed
fingers onto the page.
fingers onto the second face always reaching but I will
fingers onto the dark corner I got to fix
fingers onto the floor- grip only now
fingers onto the smallest unit to the
fingers onto the wall falling
fingers onto the middle,
fingers onto the cut
fingers onto the
fingers
finger
finge
fing
fin
fi
f

SCENE: 1

r
re
red
red stained a
red stained, i
red stained a reflection
red stained cheeks
red stained cheeks
red stained, from the wall before all
red stained, i get through the smallest unit
red stained, a wood- thin skin.
red by the one that came before.
red stained, you have me, a feeling forever
red stained, all on display objects
red stained cheeks
red stained, it worse I don
red stained stained, from my
red stained stained shattered glass
red stained cheeks
red stained stained
red
re
r

SCENE: 7

w
wo
wom
woma
woman
woman now gone
woman now with the
woman now and suture up
woman now why can' s
woman now I took me in the
woman now I beg to process reflects how
woman now, but I can' m convinced
woman now.
woman now; I hope she doesn't stick.
woman now I' ll eat it far, and
woman now, but still still I look,
woman now, music, nothing at least
woman now I travel through.
woman now, maybe it wasn
woman now; they love
woman now and time
woman now;
woman
woma
wom
wo
w

SCENE: 7

[illegible]

SCENE: 6
 g
 gr
 gri
 grie
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grief I weathered it
 grief I took a kind of
 grief
 grief
 grief I missed you could followed by surprise,
 grief
 grief I'd been carrying from eleven different relationships.
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grief I think I remember
 grief
 grief
 grief
 grie
 gri
 gr
 g

SCENE: 1
 h
 ho
 hot
 hot enough
 hot enough to look
 hot enough to feel,
 hot enough to get a gathering
 hot enough to run in your knees
 hot enough to hold me It' ll
 hot enough for a collection and tear, pummeled
 hot enough to me, but you held me?
 hot swiftly in the wrong direction.
 hot enough for what' ve come before my failings
 hot enough, so untouchable, and I'
 hot enough for long enough to endure
 hot enough to see your disowning
 hot enough I think, I
 hot enough to death before
 hot enough to offer
 hot enough
 hot
 ho
 h

SCENE: 6
 g
 gr
 gri
 grie
 grief
 grief
 grief I' ll
 grief I am i am
 grief I' m stuck with
 grief I' t what makes an
 grief I see it burns.
 grief
 grief I love to dissect her eyes.
 grief I'd been carrying from eleven different relationships.
 grief I' t let go.
 grief
 grief
 grief I see what makes you beg
 grief
 grief
 grief I will collect
 grief I'
 grief
 grie
 gri
 gr
 g

SCENE: 4
 p
 po
 pow
 powe
 power
 power; they
 power; she hero
 power; she has to
 power; replace them, a
 power I stand for you.
 power I started crying.
 power; I' s far too dark to
 power I knew a package in the first time and
 power I didn't ask, but still you knew that desperately I
 power I revealed how I wasn' ll strip me
 power I finally look, brittle, all my
 power I can' ll do you'
 power; in my failings a kind
 power; You choke on display
 power; Does everyone i
 power I possibly last
 power; replace
 power
 powe
 pow
 po
 p

SCENE: !
g
go
god
god.
god.
god, I'
god I' d
god.
god I will
god, all
god I see
god.
god I read
god I att
god I had
god I am
god, and
god.
god.
god I want
god.
god
go
g

SCENE: 6
g
gr
gri
grie
grief
grief
grief I will.
grief
grief I watch?
grief
grief
grief
grief
grief
grief I'd been carrying from eleven different relationships.
grief I loved, not not you over, but
grief I have everything I' d try?
grief
grief
grief
grief I locked doors because
grief
grief
grief
grief
grief
grief
gr
gr
g